2026-10-18 — אל אדון: The Silent Angels, the Hefsek Debate, and Dancing on Shabbos

Independent review · read fresh from the HTML alone, no transcript consulted · 18 October 2026 · 7 Cheshvan 5787 · first full draft

1.Overall Read

A ten-section write-up of roughly 5,950 words (abstract and body, before the apparatus) with a twenty-five-note *Mareh Mekomos*, built on one clean question that the first third answers well: why is the Shabbos יוצר אור longer than the weekday one? The answer arrives in two moves that work as a pair: Tosafos' six wings (III) and the creation of the angels on Monday (IV), which together explain הכל יודוך as the memory of the first Shabbos. The second third is the real argument of the piece: if the additions are so beautiful, why do Rav Saadia Gaon, the Rambam, and (as located) the Tur not say them, and why does one Rishon call them a הפסק? (V) The Or Zarua and the Magen Avraham give the practical consequence (VI). It then drifts, pleasantly, into aliyos, the Maor VaShemesh, the Zohar's dancing angels, Chassidic dancing, and a niggun.

The hard problems are five. (a) **The piece has two centres of gravity that it never connects.** I-VI argue about the *legitimacy* of the piyutim; VII-X celebrate their *joy*. The Zohar's picture (VIII) is the natural answer to the Saadia/Rambam objection (the angels danced; the piyutim recall it), but nowhere does the text say so. (b) **Section V is 1,236 words, about a fifth of the body,** and carries seven separate strands (Saadia, Rambam, Sefardim, Tur, Rabbeinu Yehuda, Rashi, the license to insert, the "say it elsewhere" proposal, the שיר המעלות aside). (c) **Participants and parentheticals crowd the narrative.** Sixty-six parentheses, ten uses of "a participant," and about a dozen first names (Naftali, Dan, Avigdor, Shlomo/Shlomi, Yosi, Yanky, Chaim

Yeshaya, Avish, Ari, Michael, Mordechai, Yossi Schwartz). (d) **The body presents a "new halachah" that the notes then qualify.** Note 15 says the Mishnah Berurah is narrower; the body now has a pointer but still reads like a ruling. (e) **There is no closing.** The piece stops on "let them sing it" and "have a wonderful week."

2.What Works

- **The opening contrast (II).** One word per letter versus a whole sentence per letter, with the two quoted openings side by side, tells the reader in four lines what the shiur is about. The unison-versus-alternating singing discussion is a good human opening.
- **The six-wings arithmetic (III-IV).** The Monday-creation *cheshbon* (five wings used, one left over for the first Shabbos) is the cleverest idea in the piece and is set out clearly in a single paragraph.
- **The machloket in V.** The sequence Saadia, Rambam, Tur, Rabbeinu Yehuda, Rashi gives the reader a clear map of "no" versus "yes," and the Rav's candour ("What happened to us?") keeps it alive.
- **The Or Zarua / Magen Avraham passage (VI).** It is the most useful page for a reader: a halachic claim, its apparent absurdity ("Did you ever see a Yid …?"), the Magen Avraham's reading, and the Rav's own "I never knew this halachah."
- **The לאשמה בה acrostic (VII).** The reader can check it letter by letter, and it is a rare moment of genuine surprise. Note 17 confirms the acrostic.
- **The Talner Rebbe's tish (IX).** Well told; the grandson's own words are kept, and the Rav's "you see how we evolve" is a good closing line for the section.
- **The apparatus is candid.** Notes 3, 5, 9, 15, 19 each correct the Rav's locus plainly and leave his words in the body.

3.Where It's Weak or Could Be Sharper

Legitimacy versus joy: bridge the two halves. After VI the reader has been told that these piyutim may be a hefsek and that one must make them up if missed. VII opens "By the way, a good yediah," which is a tangent, not a transition. A two-sentence bridge at the top of VII ("Whatever one holds about the hefsek, the closing line of שבת אשר שבתו is a gift to the Torah reading") and a one-sentence pointer at the top of VIII ("Why then did Klal Yisrael love these piyutim? The Zohar's answer") would make the shiur read as one argument. The Sefer Edition should add them.

Two reasons for the long Shabbos, not distinguished. III-IV give the reason "the angels are silent, so we sing." VIII gives a different one: "the angels sing and dance on Shabbos and we join." These are close to opposite pictures of the angels on Shabbos (silent versus dancing). The text lets both stand without comment. Say so, or have the Rav's reconciliation ("the angels are silent in their weekday song; on Shabbos they and Shabbos itself sing a new song, and we join") stated once.

Section V needs sub-headings. Seven strands in 1,236 words are too many for a continuous section. Suggested sub-headings already half-present as bold lead-ins: "The Rambam," "The Tur," "Rabbeinu Yehuda," "Rashi," "Who may insert?," "Then say it elsewhere." The שער המעלות aside (and note 14) should be cut from the book; the Rav himself says he is not sure what it concerns.

The first Shabbos: "Klal Yisrael" and "Adam HaRishon." IV says Klal Yisrael sang with the angels on the first Shabbos; the added parenthetical admits this is the Rav's phrase and points to VIII, where Adam HaRishon joins. A book should resolve this: either "the first people" or keep "Klal Yisrael" as the Rav's shorthand and say so in a note.

Participants. A reader in 2030 does not know who Dan, Avigdor, Shlomi, Yanky or Avish are. Replace names with "a participant" or "someone in the room" throughout the book text, keep only the Rav's named sources (Wolfson, Zuckerman as the one who raised the singing, the Edelman family, Ari as

sponsor). The jokes about congregants (Section V's "first to be sent home," Section VII's hosafot banter) can be shortened.

Reportage voice. "The Rav" appears 61 times; "the Rav says" or "the Rav adds" opens a large share of the paragraphs in V-VII. For the Sefer Edition, convert to direct exposition for the Rav's lomdus (VI is almost there) and keep the reporting voice for the stories (VIII, IX).

The ending. The shiur's actual emotional high point is the Zohar's chasunah ("It was Simchas Torah, it was Purim up in shamayim") and the tish. The last section, on the niggun and the Rokeach, is thin (297 words) and the final exchange (KAJ, ערוך לך) is unexplained. Consider ending the Sefer Edition on the Talner tish or on the Rav's line "That's the mode a Yid is supposed to be in on Shabbos Kodesh."

4.Factual / Citation Concerns

The wings verse (III, note 3). The body keeps "Yechezkel" with a bracket pointing to Yeshayahu 6:2; note 3 says Yechezkel 1:6 has four wings. Good. But the body's phrase "the pasuk ... שש כנפים לאחד quotes a verse whose words are not exactly Yeshayahu's (שש כנפים שש כנפים לאחד); say "the verse about the six wings" and put the exact wording in the note.

"The Tosafos" is carrying more than it can (III, note 3). The body has Hakadosh Baruch Hu silencing the angels and saying "I want to hear my children." Note 3 says only the opening of the Tosafos was retrieved, that it speaks of חיות, and that the Rav's detail was not located.

Because the whole shiur turns on this, the book should print the Tosafos' own words (as located) next to the Rav's rendering.

The day of the angels' creation (IV, VIII, note 5). The body now says "the fourth day (the Midrash has the fifth; see note 5)" in IV, but VIII repeats "on the fourth day" without the pointer. Fix both. Also: the body's "Rashi implies it" is not found in the Rashi passages checked (note 5); "Rashi" should be printed as "the Rav says Rashi implies it."

Berachos (IV, note 6). The body says the Gemara in Berachos on "the

first דף; the note corrects to 4b. The body's "first daf" is itself odd

(Berachos 4 is the fourth daf); change to "Berachos 4."

The Tur and Toledo (V, note 9). The pointer in the body is good. But

the body keeps the Rav's "we never said לא אדון for Toledo; the Tur as

located names only לא אשר שבת. The sentence "the Tur grew up as a

child in Ashkenaz, then moved ... best of both worlds" is the Rav's history

and is not checked; the note says so but nothing marks it in the body.

Rabbeinu Yehuda ben Barzilai (V, note 10). "Contemporary of the

Rif ... late eleventh century" is the Rav's dating, and is not ספר העתים

located. Print "the Rav dates him to the late eleventh century."

Rashi in Sefer HaPardes (V, note 11). The body gives "our *heilige*

Rashi" as the author; note 11 says the work is generally attributed to

Rashi's school. A book should say "the *Sefer HaPardes*, attributed to Rashi" in the body.

The Or Zarua and Magen Avraham (VI, note 15). The body's "The Magen Avraham is *mechadesh a chiddush* ... if you ever missed these piyutim you have to go back" is the Rav's. Note 15 shows the Rema and Mishnah Berurah limit it to לא אשר שבת and that the Chayei Adam rules against skipping. In a book edition the practical halachah must be stated correctly, or the passage should say "as the Rav understands the Magen Avraham" in the first sentence rather than in a closing pointer.

Also, note 15 is the longest note (about 330 words); split it.

Megillah (VII, note 19). The body repeats "שבעת סריסים as the participant's phrase; note 19 shows the Gemara's source is the seven who

saw the king's face. That is a useful correction, but a reader of the body alone is left with the wrong phrase; add "(the seven who saw the king's face, Esther 1:14; see note 19)."

Imrei Noam (VII, note 18). The body says "written by the holy Jikover, a son of the Ropshitzer Rav"; note 18 suggests a grandson. If the genealogy is wrong, the body should say "the Dzikover (the Rav says: a son of the Ropshitzer)." Also check "Jikover" against the book's spelling (Dzikover).

Zohar and Avodah Zarah (VIII, notes 20-21). The Zohar story is not located, and the Avodah Zarah daf does not say what the Rav says it says. Both are flagged in the notes; the body, however, has the Rav say "that's what the Gemara says in Avodah Zarah" as fact. Prefix "as the Rav

understands." The "*uvdin d'chol*" objection is noted and unanswered.

Rav Elazar Halevi Landa (IX, note 23). The identification is by name only; the body adds "a huge תלמיד חכם" as the Rav's description. The quotation is explicitly the Rav's English rendering (note 23), but the body sets it in italics as if quoted. Mark it as paraphrase.

Dates and internal consistency. 18 October 2026 = 7 Cheshvan 5787 is correct (11 October was 30 Tishrei, Rosh Chodesh Cheshvan). The Spinker Rebbe "was here on Shabbos" is dated only by the shiur date; in print add "Shabbos Parashas Noach." (That date is the editor's; verify the weekly portion with the calendar.)

Footnotes and the "note-academic" flags: what a book edition must resolve or move to endnotes

All twenty-five notes carry a bold "Flag." Sorted by what the flag says:

- **Verified, with only an editor's identification needed:** 4 (Chullin 91b), 6 (Berachos 4b), 8 (Rambam), 13 (SA 54:3), 16 (SA 138:1), 19 (Megillah 23a), 22 (SA 339:3). Seven notes; absorb into clean citations.

- **Corrected the Rav's locus or wording:** 3 (Yeshayahu not Yechezkel), 5 (fifth day), 9 (Tur names only one piyut), 19 (officers, not eunuchs), 21 (Avodah Zarah does not say it). Five notes; promote the correction into the body text of the book.

- **Oral testimony or custom:** 17 (the Spinka custom), 23 (Talner tish), 24 (Wolfson). These go in the body as attributed reports.

- **Genuinely unresolved, needs a library:** 1, 2, 7, 10, 11, 12, 14, 15 (Magen Avraham/Or Zarua texts), 18, 20, 25. Eleven notes.

Problems that apply to the apparatus as a whole:

- **Voice.** "Editor's identification," "not located," "the Rav's report" appear in almost every note; a book needs a clean source line and a separate editorial log.

- **Platform versus source.** "Sefaria" appears about thirty times in the notes. A book cites the work and place, not the website.

- **Note 15 versus the body.** See Section 4.

- **Body text that is itself note-like.** Pointers such as "(see note 9 ...)", "(see note 5 ...)", "(the name is as heard on the recording)", "(not expanded on the recording ...)" belong to the web edition only.

5.Small Polish Suggestions

- **Transliteration to unify:** *hosafot / hosafos* (the body uses *hosafot*; the

project's other write-ups use *-os*); *Chassidishe / Chassidic*; *kivayachol*; *mashlim / be'mashlim*; *Kel Odon* (title) versus אל אדון (body, which is never transliterated after Section II).

- **Hebrew pointing policy.** Quoted blocks are fully pointed; the verse in VII is pointed; running Hebrew is not. That is the same policy as the earlier write-ups; keep it.
- **"YILC" and "KAJ."** Unexplained abbreviations, now flagged as such in the text. Drop or expand in the book.
- **The war joke (V).** "A particular congregant would be the first to be sent home" is harmless but pointless without the name; cut in the book.
- **The abstract.** At about 330 words it is longer than most sections; trim to the question, the answer (wings), the machloket, the halachah, and the joy.

- **Section VII's title** lists three topics; the aliyah/hosafot discussion is the least connected; consider splitting into "Ending on a דבר טוב" and "The Zohar's Picture" with a shorter VII.

Consolidated recommended edits (for the Sefer Edition rewrite)

1. Add a bridge between VI and VII and between VII and VIII (legitimacy to joy).
2. State once the relation between "the angels are silent" and "the angels dance" (III-IV versus VIII).
3. Sub-head Section V; cut the שיר המעלות aside and note 14.
4. Resolve "Klal Yisrael" on the first Shabbos; fix "fourth day" in VIII; "Berachos 4" for "first daf."
5. Print the Tosafos' wording next to the Rav's rendering.
6. Qualify the Or Zarua / Magen Avraham passage in its first sentence;

split note 15.

7. Put the seven who saw the king's face (Esther 1:14) in the body beside the participant's "שבעת סריסים."
8. Remove participants' names; keep the Rav's sources and the Wolfson testimony.
9. Mark the Talner-tish quotation as paraphrase; mark Avodah Zarah as the Rav's understanding.
10. Close on the Zohar's chasunah or the Talner tish rather than on the niggun exchange.

6.Bottom Line

> *A lively, well-organized write-up of a short shiur with an unusually high ratio of source-claims to minutes, and an apparatus that is honest about what it could not find. As a web page it works. The strongest part is the first half (wings, Monday, יודוך', the Saadia/Rambam/Rashi machloket); the weakest is the connective tissue, the crowd of participants' names, and a practical halachah (the Or Zarua and Magen Avraham) that the notes qualify but the body does not. With bridges between the legitimacy half and the joy half, a sub-headed Section V, a few corrections moved from the notes into the body, and a stronger ending, it would stand as a Sefer Edition chapter.*

Independent editorial review of the English write-up only. The reviewer read the HTML as a stranger would and did not consult the recording, the transcripts, or the earlier reviews. *caveat lector*.